Ode to Joy

Ludwig van Beethoven, 1824

Key: **C major** Time: **4/4** Tempo: **100 bpm** Picked: **Up, twice a bar**

The pattern

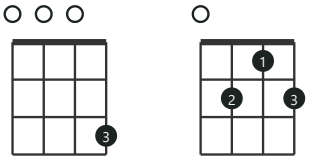
Up, twice a bar `g C E A`

The same four strings in eighths: twice through in a bar of 4/4.

Count	1	&	2	&	3	&	4	&
Finger	p	i	m	a	p	i	m	a
String	g	C	E	A	g	C	E	A

Fingers: p thumb · i index · m middle · a ring. + means picked together; · is a rest. Hold the whole chord shape and pick from it: every fret number in the tab is already under a finger.

The chords



C G7

The song

VERSE 1

```
  C               G7              C               G7
A|------3-------3-|------2-------2-|------3-------3-|------2-------2-|
E|----0-------0---|----1-------1---|----0-------0---|----1-------1---|
C|--0-------0-----|--2-------2-----|--0-------0-----|--2-------2-----|
G|0-------0-------|0-------0-------|0-------0-------|0-------0-------|
  Joyful, joyful,  we adore Thee,   God of glory,    Lord of love;

  C                       G7                      C               G7     C
A|---------3-----------3--|---------2-----------2--|------3-------3-|------2-------3-|
E|------0-----------0-----|------1-----------1-----|----0-------0---|----1-------0---|
C|---0-----------0--------|---2-----------2--------|--0-------0-----|--2-------0-----|
G|0-----------0-----------|0-----------0-----------|0-------0-------|0-------0-------|
  Hearts unfold like       flow'rs before Thee,     op'ning to the   sun a   bove.

  G7                      C                       G7                      C      G7
A|---------2-----------2--|---------3-----------3--|---------2-----------2--|------3-------2-|
E|------1-----------1-----|------0-----------0-----|------1-----------1-----|----0-------1---|
C|---2-----------2--------|---0-----------0--------|---2-----------2--------|--0-------2-----|
G|0-----------0-----------|0-----------0-----------|0-----------0-----------|0-------0-------|
  Melt the clouds of       sin and sadness;         drive the dark of        doubt a way;
```

```
  C               G7                    C                     G7         C
A|------3-------3-|---------2-----------2--|---------3-----------3--|---------2--------3-|
E|----0-------0---|------1-----------1-----|------0-----------0-----|------1---------0---|
C|--0-------0-----|---2-----------2--------|---0-----------0--------|---2----------0-----|
G|0-------0-------|0-----------0-----------|0-----------0-----------|0-----------0-------|
  Giver of im      mortal gladness,         fill us with the         light of    day!
```

VERSE 2

```
  C                     G7                    C                     G7
A|---------3-----------3--|---------2-----------2--|---------3-----------3--|------2-------2-|
E|------0-----------0-----|------1-----------1-----|------0-----------0-----|----1-------1---|
C|---0-----------0--------|---2-----------2--------|---0-----------0--------|--2-------2-----|
G|0-----------0-----------|0-----------0-----------|0-----------0-----------|0-------0-------|
  All Thy works with       joy surround Thee,       earth and heaven re      flect Thy rays,

  C                     G7                    C                 G7      C
A|---------3-----------3--|---------2-----------2--|------3-------3-|------2-------3-|
E|------0-----------0-----|------1-----------1-----|----0-------0---|----1-------0---|
C|---0-----------0--------|---2-----------2--------|--0-------0-----|--2-------0-----|
G|0-----------0-----------|0-----------0-----------|0-------0-------|0-------0-------|
  stars and angels         sing around Thee,        centre of un     broken  praise.

  G7                    C                     G7                C          G7
A|---------2-----------2--|---------3-----------3--|------2-------2-|---------3--------2-|
E|------1-----------1-----|------0-----------0-----|----1-------1---|------0---------1---|
C|---2-----------2--------|---0-----------0--------|--2-------2-----|---0----------2-----|
G|0-----------0-----------|0-----------0-----------|0-------0-------|0-----------0-------|
  Field and forest,        vale and mountain,       flow'ry meadow,  flashing    sea,

  C                     G7                    C                     G7         C
A|---------3-----------3--|---------2-----------2--|------3-------3-|---------2--------3-|
E|------0-----------0-----|------1-----------1-----|----0-------0---|------1---------0---|
C|---0-----------0--------|---2-----------2--------|--0-------0-----|---2----------0-----|
G|0-----------0-----------|0-----------0-----------|0-------0-------|0-----------0-------|
  singing bird and         flowing fountain         call us to re    joice in    Thee.
```

How to learn it

1. Hold one chord and play the pattern over and over, slowly, until your picking hand does it on its own.
2. Change chords on beat 1: the new shape has to be down by the time your thumb picks.
3. Then the song, slowly (Pick → Play, with the practice speed turned down), up to speed over a few days.

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